
TV tonight: a body is found in a clever surrealist period drama

Published by

Jack Seale, Ali Catterall, Graeme Virtue, Hannah J Davies

Estimated reading time

1 min

Added on

2026-04-29

Address

<https://www.theguardian.com/tv-and-radio/2026/apr/29/tv-tonight-surrealists-face-the-very-real-prospect-of-a-murder-investigation>

TV tonight: a body is found in a clever surrealist period drama

This Is Not a Murder Mystery

8pm, U&Drama

A period crime drama set in West Sussex, 1936: a stately home is playing host to the hottest artists of the day, including Salvador Dalí, Man Ray and René Magritte. After a party fuelled by cocaine, opium and professional jealousy, a body is found, staged like Magritte's *The Lovers* – prompting the arrival of Stephen Tompkinson as acerbic DCI John Thistlethwaite. The clever visual references and arch dialogue make it hard not to love. *Jack Seale*

A Taste for Murder

9pm, ITV1

New drama in which delicious Italian cuisine and brutal murder come together. When grieving widower DCI Joe Mottram (Warren Brown) and his daughter Angelica (Beau Gadsdon) seek solace in sunny Capri, Joe is soon asked by his mother-in-law (Phyllis Logan) to clear a relative's name. Cue soft-focus closeups of risotto, cookery tips and corpses. *Ali Catterall*

Salisbury Poisonings: The Untold Story

9pm, Channel 4

This three-parter revisits the attempted murder of Russian double agent Sergei Skripal and his daughter Yulia on UK soil in 2018. The opening episode hears from local responders who had no idea a lethal nerve agent was involved, and offers an insider's perspective on how the government weighed up its diplomatic response. *Graeme Virtue*

The Betrayal of Anne Boleyn: Inside the Tower of London Special

9pm, Channel 5

The Crown's Jason Watkins and historian Tracy Borman present this one-off about the tawdry accusations that led to the demise of Henry VIII's second spouse. From Boleyn's childhood home, Hever Castle, to the National Archives, the pair dig deep in a watertight documentary that's no vanity project for Tudor buff Watkins. *Hannah J Davies*

The 'Burbs

9pm, Sky One

The plot continues to clot in this kooky comedy, where nosy neighbours have united to unmask a prickly incomer as a bad 'un. It falls to young couple Samira (Keke Palmer) and Rob (Jack Whitehall) to tail their suspect, and a stakeout is the perfect venue for Whitehall's Sean Connery impression. *GV*

Twenty Twenty Six

10pm, BBC Two

Sarah's "wooden condoms" gaffe has gone viral. Or, as Twenty Twenty Six puts it, "there's been a lively response to her appearance on a podcast to promote a sustainability agenda". Can she leverage the attention to discuss the plight of polar bears? Meanwhile, a famous footballer is about to announce he is gay. As Ian says: "We cannot afford to get this wrong ..." *AC*

Produced by wallabag with tcpdf

Please open [an issue](#) if you have trouble with the display of this E-Book on your device.